

(5) Belshazzar was Neriglissar (*Nergal-šar-ušur*), and hence a son-in-law of Nebuchadnezzar.⁶⁰

(6) Belshazzar was Laborosoarchod (*Lābāši-Marduk*), and hence a grandson of Nebuchadnezzar.⁶¹

(7) Belshazzar and Nabonidus were two different names of the last Neo-Babylonian king.⁶²

(8) Nabonidus was a son-in-law of Nebuchadnezzar. Therefore his son Belshazzar was a grandson of Nebuchadnezzar.⁶³

3. Scope of the Present Inquiry

The most tenable of the foregoing hypotheses will be revealed as the discussion proceeds. Fortunately we are dependent no longer upon pure supposition in dealing with the problem. There is now available a rich and valuable accumulation of Babylonian texts making specific reference to Nabonidus and Belshazzar. These new contemporaneous sources of information have thrown so much light upon the period under investigation that it is necessary to revise former critical and historical conclusions. It is now possible to prove

annis 6; Tertius Baltassar, annis 5. According to the theory of Anniius, *Nergal-šar-ušur*, *Lābāši-Marduk*, and *Bēl-šar-ušur* were the first, second, and third sons of *Amēl-Marduk*.

⁶⁰ See Boscawen in *TSBA* VI, pp. 28, 29, 43, where the attempt is made to connect Belshazzar with *Marduk-šar-ušur*, misread for *Nergal-šar-ušur*. Syncellus associated Belshazzar with Neriglissar in his list of Neo-Babylonian kings *juxta ecclesiasticum computum*. See p. 10.

⁶¹ See Scaliger, *Isagogicorum chronologiae canonum libri tres* III, p. 190; Ebrard, *Comm. zur Offenbarung Johannis*, p. 45; Hofmann, *Die 70 Jahre*, p. 44. Prince, *op. cit.*, quotes these references.

⁶² As has already been indicated in note 26, Josephus thought that Baltasar (Belshazzar) and Naboandelus (Nabonidus) were the same person. Some commentators accepted this view of Josephus, e.g. Bertholdt, Bleek, Browne, Ewald, Hävernicks, Hengstenberg, Herzfeld, Kirms, and Michaelis. See Prince, *op. cit.*, p. 29, for references.

⁶³ George Rawlinson in his work entitled *Herodotus* I, p. 424, advanced this view, which may be summarized as follows: Nabonidus when he came to the throne would naturally want to make his position secure by allying himself with the family of Nebuchadnezzar. "He may have taken to wife Neriglissar's widow, or he may have married some other daughter of Nebuchadnezzar. Belshazzar may thus have been the grandson of Nebuchadnezzar on the mother's side." Rawlinson believed in the probability of such an alliance of Nabonidus with the house of Nebuchadnezzar because of the indications that Nabonidus had a son named after Nebuchadnezzar. See *KA* pp. 23ff and p. 55.